

A 21-DAY IMMERSION

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

DISCOVER THE PHILIPPINES

A cinematic passage through living mountain cultures, storied streets, wild encounters and restorative island days.

TRAVEL DEEPER. RETURN CHANGED.

START HERE

The Philippines, at a glance

An archipelago best understood not by ticking off islands, but by noticing how landscape, language and hospitality change from one crossing to the next.



ARCHIPELAGO

More than 7,600 islands across Luzon, Visayas and Mindanao.



LANGUAGE

Filipino and English are official; many regional languages are spoken.



CURRENCY

Philippine peso (PHP). Cards are common in cities; cash matters in remote areas.



CLIMATE

Tropical and maritime. Dry season generally Dec-May; rainfall patterns vary by region.



TIME

UTC+8 - six hours ahead of Copenhagen in Danish winter, seven in summer.



POPULATION

112,729,484 people at the July 2024 census.

THE FEELING

Warm welcomes, long road journeys, salt on your skin, and a pace that invites conversation. Build in pauses: the unscheduled hours are part of the destination.

TRAVEL WELL

Before the first crossing

**ENTRY**

Many visa-exempt visitors are admitted for 30 days. Carry a passport valid at least six months beyond the intended stay and proof of onward travel. Rules depend on nationality - verify before departure.

**BUDGET**

This is a premium, privately coordinated journey. The meaningful budget drivers are season, room category, domestic flights and private touring; request a tailored land quote rather than relying on a generic daily average.

**GETTING AROUND**

Use private vehicles for the Cordillera and city transfers; domestic flights for long jumps; ferries and bancas for island passages. Leave generous buffers around sea and air connections.

**MONEY**

Carry small peso notes for markets, tips and remote stops. Use ATMs in major cities before mountain and coastal sectors; tell your bank you are travelling.

**WEATHER**

December-May is broadly drier, but the country has several rainfall patterns. Pack a breathable rain layer and reef-safe sun protection, and keep plans flexible in tropical weather.

**CONNECTIVITY**

An eSIM or local SIM is useful. Signal can soften in mountain villages and at sea - download key documents and maps for offline use.

ESSENTIAL CHECK

Travel insurance, prescribed medication, light layers, sturdy walking shoes, sandals, dry bag, modest temple/church clothing and copies of important documents.

THE ARC OF THE JOURNEY

Twenty-one days, held loosely

The route moves from city energy into mountain stillness, along a heritage coast, and finally toward open water. It is intentionally generous: discovery followed by rest, then discovery again.

MANILA**2 NIGHTS***arrival + living history***BANAUE****3 NIGHTS***terraces + time***SAGADA****2 NIGHTS***ritual landscape***VIGAN****3 NIGHTS***heritage + a free day***DONSOL****4 NIGHTS***wildlife + sea air***BOHOL****3 NIGHTS***geology + resort ease***MOALBOAL****1 NIGHT***one marine immersion***CEBU****2 NIGHTS***soft landing + farewell***DESIGN PRINCIPLE**

No sightseeing for sightseeing's sake. Every active day is answered by space to swim, read, linger over lunch or simply watch the weather move.

MANILA | THE THRESHOLD

Begin in motion

The city does not reveal itself all at once. It arrives as jeepney chrome, tropical shade, polished hotel calm and the old stone walls of Intramuros.

LOOK CLOSER

Fort Santiago and San Agustin Church frame stories of empire, faith and resistance; a kalesa slows the city to hoofbeats.

THE PAUSE

Return to The Peninsula early. Pool, spa and a quiet dinner let the body arrive before the route begins.

TASTE

Let lunch introduce sour, smoky and savoury Filipino notes - then follow curiosity, not a checklist.

BANAUE | A LIVING LANDSCAPE

Where mountains remember

At Batad, the path bends with the contours. Water, forest, stone and cultivation form a system that is cultural knowledge as much as scenery.

UNESCO CONTEXT

Batad is one of five inscribed terrace clusters in the Rice Terraces of the Philippine Cordilleras, a living Ifugao cultural landscape.

EXPERIENCE

Walk with a local guide, notice traditional houses and irrigation, and listen before photographing.

ROOM TO BREATHE

The third day is deliberately open: breakfast with mountain views, reading, family time, perhaps a short village walk.

SAGADA | HIGH COUNTRY

Listen to the silence

Morning gathers slowly in Sagada. Pine air, clouded ridges and Kankanaey stories give this highland stop an atmosphere entirely its own.

CHOOSE YOUR PACE

Follow Echo Valley toward the hanging coffins with cultural interpretation, or choose an active cave and mountain walk.

TRAVEL WITH CARE

Burial traditions are not spectacle. Follow local rules, keep voices low, and ask before photographing people or sacred places.

AFTERWARDS

Return early. Tea, cool air and an unhurried evening are part of why Sagada stays with you.



VIGAN | STREETS OF MEMORY

History at walking pace

Calle Crisologo is most evocative at the edges of the day, when stone streets, timber houses and capiz-shell windows begin to hold the light.

WHY IT MATTERS

UNESCO describes Vigan as Asia's best-preserved example of a planned Spanish colonial town, shaped by Philippine, Chinese and European influences.

MEET THE CRAFT

Go beyond façades: seek inabel weaving, ancestral-house details and an Ilocano lunch.

YOUR DAY

One full day remains unscripted. Do as much or as little as you wish.

DONSOL | WILD ENCOUNTER

Follow the butanding

Before sunrise, the boat slips into open water. The encounter is never guaranteed - and that uncertainty is precisely what keeps it wild.

ETHICAL ENCOUNTER

Donsol's whale-shark interactions take place without artificial feeding and are led by trained interaction officers.

IN THE WATER

Follow the briefing, keep respectful distance and let the animal set the rhythm.

FOUR-NIGHT EXHALE

Balance one early marine morning with beach time, pool time, and an optional mangrove firefly cruise.

BOHOL | GEOLOGY & GRACE

An island raised from the sea

The Chocolate Hills appear almost imagined: smooth cones across the green interior, formed from limestone linked to ancient coral reef deposits.

A GLOBAL GEOPARK

Bohol became the Philippines' first UNESCO Global Geopark in 2023, recognising an island story shaped by more than 150 million years of geology.

A GENTLE HALF-DAY

Pair the hills with responsible tarsier conservation, countryside roads and a local lunch.

RESORT RHYTHM

Back at Amorita, the afternoon belongs to shade, saltwater and family time.

MOALBOAL | BENEATH THE SURFACE

Enter the silver current

A dense ribbon of sardines turns as one body. From below, the water flickers; from above, the shoal seems to redraw the sea.

ONE MARINE DAY

Certified divers can take a private reef dive; non-divers and children can snorkel the sardine run and look for turtles.

GOOD PRACTICE

Choose trained local operators, never touch wildlife or coral, and use fins with care in shallow water.

THE POINT

This is not a race for sightings. It is a chance to feel briefly inside a living system.



CEBU | THE SOFT LANDING

End with ease

The final chapter is comfortable by design: a private transfer, a restorative hotel, perhaps a little history, then time to choose what the last day needs.

OPTIONAL CULTURE

The Basilica Minore del Santo Niño and Magellan's Cross connect Cebu to the early history of Christianity in Asia.

CITY OR RESORT

Choose Shangri-La Mactan for a final resort mood, or Radisson Blu for city access and shopping.

FAREWELL

A relaxed Filipino dinner, late check-out where possible, and an unhurried airport transfer.



THE THREAD BETWEEN PLACES

Come to the table

Travel becomes personal over shared dishes: the explanation of a recipe, the second helping, the story that would never fit inside a tour commentary.

EAT REGIONALLY

Taste Ilocano cooking in Vigan, highland produce in the Cordillera, seafood in Bicol and Visayan flavours in Bohol and Cebu.

ASK, THEN LISTEN

A few words of Filipino - salamat for thank you - are welcomed. English is widely spoken, but warmth travels further than fluency.

LEAVE SPACE

Not every meal needs to be "the best." A simple bowl, eaten where daily life is happening, may become the one you remember.

TRAVEL NOTES

Useful, current, considered

Facts in this edition were checked against official sources in August 2026. Entry, weather and operating conditions can change; Abbey's Road reconfirms the details that affect your departure.

ENTRY & EXTENSIONS**Philippine Bureau of Immigration**

immigration.gov.ph/visas/visa-waiver/

WEATHER & SEASONS**DOST-PAGASA**

pagasa.dost.gov.ph/information/climate-philippines

POPULATION**Philippine Statistics Authority - 2024 POPCEN**

psa.gov.ph/content/2024-census-population-popcen-population-counts-declared-official-president

BANAUE & VIGAN**UNESCO World Heritage Centre**

whc.unesco.org/en/list/722/ | whc.unesco.org/en/list/502/

BOHOL GEOPARK**UNESCO Global Geoparks**

unesco.org/en/igpp/geoparks/bohol-island

DONSOL & CEBU**Philippine Department of Tourism**

tourism.gov.ph/destination/bicol-region/sorsogon/ | tourism.gov.ph/destination/central-visayas/

BEFORE YOU GO

Verify passport and entry eligibility, purchase comprehensive insurance, review the latest weather outlook and accept that wildlife and sea conditions remain beautifully beyond anyone's control.

YOUR PHILIPPINES, DESIGNED AROUND YOU

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

DISCOVER THE PHILIPPINES

Tell us how you like to move, what your family is curious about, and where you want more stillness. We will shape the route, stays and private logistics into one seamless journey.

START PLANNING YOUR JOURNEY

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